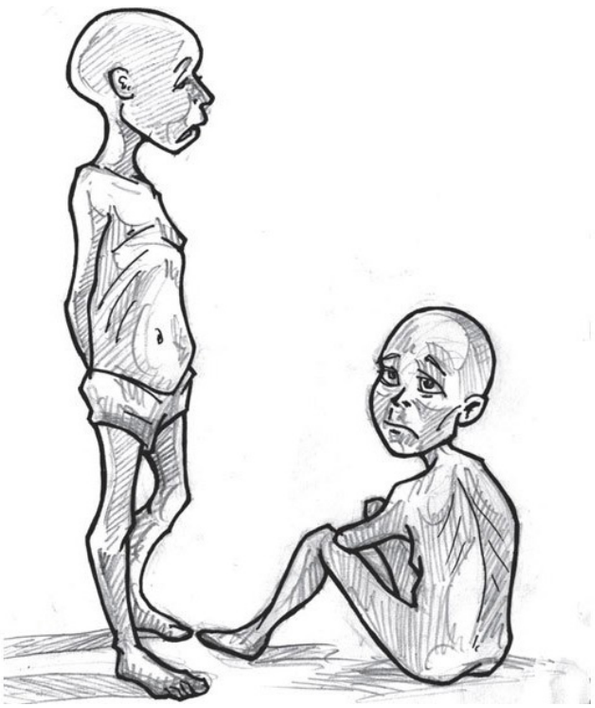
Nutrients

Macro nutrients
- Carbohydrates
- Proteins
- Lipids/fats

Micro nutrients
Vitamins
Minerals



Poorly nourished children



Wellnourished children

▲ Fig. 1 Depiction of Poorly nourished children and wellnourished children

5.2 MACRONUTRIENTS

Macronutrients refer to the nutrients that are needed in large quantities. They are broadly classified as carbohydrates, protein and lipids/fats.

5.2.1 Carbohydrates

- **Definition:** Carbohydrates are sugars or polymers of sugars such as starch that can be hydrolyzed to simple sugars by the action of digestive enzymes or by heating with dilute acids. Generally but not always, the hydrogen and oxygen in them are in proportion to form water, hence the term carbohydrate.

  The predominant function of the carbohydrates is to provide energy needed by our body. Starch found in cereals and sugar in sugarcane and fruits are examples of carbohydrates in foods.
- **Classification:** The dietary carbohydrates are classified as:

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